1 · THE AD

A 15-second storyboard

Portrait 9:16, readable with the sound off: the satisfying unravel first, then the spool rule and the tray, then the layer that sets the game apart, then a challenge the viewer wants to answer.

0–2 s · Hook

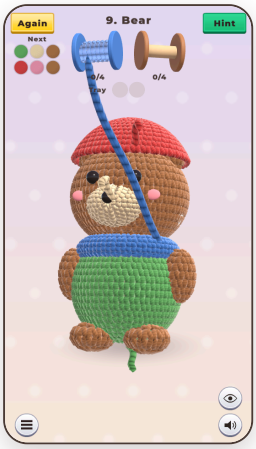


The bear, half unravelled: stuffing shows where its rounds were.

UNRAVEL THE BEAR

Sound: Soft pops, rising

2–4 s · The rule



A tap on the scarf: a blue round reels onto the blue spool.

MATCH THE SPOOL

Sound: Yarn whirr

4–6 s · Fill



Four rounds: the spool is full and about to pop.

4 ROUNDS, POP!

Sound: Pop

6–8 s · The tray



No red spool open: the castle's flag waits in the tray.

NO SPOOL? IT WAITS

Sound: Soft thud

8–9.5 s · The twist



A finger holds the eye: the sweater turns see-through.

WHAT'S UNDER THE SWEATER?

Sound: Shimmer

9.5–11 s · Challenge

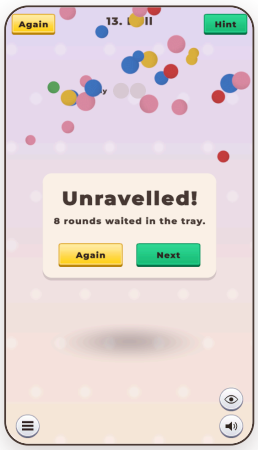


Level 13: a doll in a doll in a doll, and a tray of 2.

3 DOLLS. CAN YOU?

Sound: Music drops

11–13.5 s · Payoff



The last round goes: yarn balls rain on the Unravelled card.

UNRAVELLED!

Sound: Win jingle

13.5–15 s · End card



All 13 toys; the edit lays the title and a Play button over it.

UNSTITCHED · PLAY FREE

Sound: Jingle ends

Every frame is real. The PlayMode tests (`ToyTests`) play the toys in the real scene and save screenshots; these are picked from them. The ad itself would be cut from a screen recording of the same moments.

2 · THE CPI TEST

Three hooks, one decision

A hyper-casual prototype's first question is not "is it fun?" but "will people install it cheaply enough?"

Creative variants

VARIANT	FIRST 2 SECONDS	WHAT IT TESTS
A · Unravel (above)	A toy coming apart stitch by stitch, stuffing showing	The texture itself; the widest audience
B · Tangle	The tray fills, "Tangled!", then "Can you do better?"	The genre's fail hook: puzzle players who want to fix it
C · The eye	Close-up: the eye turns a sweater see-through; a surprise colour underneath	Is the hidden layer itself the hook? (the game's difference)

Test design

	SETTING (PLANNING ASSUMPTIONS)
Channels	Meta (Facebook/Instagram) first; an ad network after a pass
Geo and build	US Android, behind a store listing with analytics on (an Android build is still to make)
Rounds	Up to three creative rounds before the kill decision; change the hook first, as it is the cheapest
Reading	Compare variants only once each has enough impressions for its CTR to settle

Go / iterate / kill

Go

- CPI under $0.30 [1]
- CTR above 2% [2]
- IPM above 80 on Android [2]
- D1 at least 38% on Android [1]
- Day-7 playtime per user over 2,000 s [1]

Soft launch with the KPI plan overleaf.

Iterate

- CTR good but CPI over the line: the store page loses them (icon, first screenshot)
- CPI good but D1 short: the first minutes (levels 1–5) lose them
- Neither: try the next hook

Kill

- After three creative rounds, no variant within reach of the go line on CPI
- Or D1 stays near the genre median (19% on Android [3]) even with a good CPI

The idea is not landing: test a new theme for the same rules before more content.

Where the lines come from. The go thresholds are quoted from publishers' published guidance (sources below). For scale: across hyper-casual games in Q3 2022, the median Android D1 was 19% and the top 2% reached 42% [3]. Each publisher sets its own lines; these are a starting point, to be replaced by the publisher's own benchmarks.

[1] Supersonic: "The 3 most important KPIs for testing your hyper-casual prototype", supersonic.com/learn/blog/the-3-most-important-kpis-for-testing-your-hyper-casual-prototype

[2] Ivan Fedyanin (Ducky), PocketGamer.biz, 17 June 2021: "What are the key KPIs for a successful hypercasual game?", pocketgamer.biz/comment-and-opinion/76718/ducky-ivan-fedyanin-key-hypercasual-kpis

[3] Tenjin and GameAnalytics, Q3 2022: "Hypercasual benchmarks (via Game Dev Reports, 11 October 2022)", gamedevreports.substack.com/p/tenjin-and-gameanalytics-hypercasual

3 · KPI PLAN

What to measure, and what to change

The prototype has no analytics yet. These are the events to add, each tied to a question the design needs answered.

EVENT (TO ADD)	FIELDS	ANSWERS
`level_start`	level, attempt	Where players stop (the level funnel)
`level_end`	level, result, pulls, rounds_in_tray, seconds, hints	Is the curve right? Tangles and tray use per toy
`hint_used`	level, pull_number	Which toys are walls, and at which pull
`eye_held`	level, seconds	Do players find the eye (level 5), and use it before they pull?
`pull_refused`	level, part, reason	Is sewing readable? ("held" refusals on the cat and the castle)
`session_start`	day_since_install, level	Retention (D1, D7)

KPIs and targets

KPI	TARGET OR BENCHMARK	IF IT MISSES
D1 retention	≥ 38% Android [1]	The first minutes: levels 1–5, the tray (3) and the eye (5)
D7 retention	Benchmark: the top 2% of hyper-casual reach 16% on Android [3]	Pacing; 13 toys may be too few to hold a week
Eye use on level 5	Set from the first cohort	Players don't find the eye: rework the bunny's tip or point at it
Tangles per toy	Compare with the random player (workbook)	Where people and bots disagree, people are right: re-pick the order
Rounds in the tray	Compare with the solver's fewest (workbook)	A toy whose best line still fills the tray (the doll) may read as unfair

Watch these toys first

A random player wins least often on **9 Bear, 11 Cake, 12 Gift, 13 Doll**, and a careful player falls furthest behind random on **10 Rocket, 8 Snowman**, where reading ahead matters most. Bots aren't people, but these are the first places to look in the funnel and the hint data.

Nothing guessed

Targets with a source carry its number; the rest are set from the first real cohort instead of guessed. The bots' curve in the workbook is the baseline the real data is read against.

[1] Supersonic: "The 3 most important KPIs for testing your hyper-casual prototype", supersonic.com/learn/blog/the-3-most-important-kpis-for-testing-your-hyper-casual-prototype
[2] Ivan Fedyanin (Ducky), PocketGamer.biz, 17 June 2021: "What are the key KPIs for a successful hypercasual game?", pocketgamer.biz/comment-and-opinion/76718/ducky-ivan-fedyanin-key-hypercasual-kpis
[3] Tenjin and GameAnalytics, Q3 2022: "Hypercasual benchmarks (via Game Dev Reports, 11 October 2022)", gamedevreports.substack.com/p/tenjin-and-gameanalytics-hypercasual